



NATIONAL SCIENCE FOUNDATION

Business Model Canvas (BMC)

(Please give the requested information with brief explanations as appropriate)

1. Project Title <i>(Title should express the expected output of the project)</i>
Enclave: Commercialization of a Secure On-Premise AI Platform for Institutional Knowledge and Talent Intelligence
2. Customer Segment <i>(Please briefly describe for whom the company is giving your product or service and Who is the most important customer category of your company?) Maximum 200 words</i>
Enclave targets organisations that must handle sensitive documents internally and are structurally unable to adopt foreign cloud-based AI tools. Three primary segments: (i) Public sector. Government ministries, state-owned enterprises, and regulatory bodies that manage policy documents, minutes, approvals, circulars, and citizen data under the Personal Data Protection Act (No. 9 of 2022) and the ICTA Government Cloud Policy. (ii) Public higher education. Sri Lanka's 17 state universities and 19 higher education institutes, which generate high volumes of administrative, academic, and policy documents continuously, and face data-sovereignty and governance obligations comparable to government bodies. (iii) Regulated private enterprise. Mid-to-large private enterprises (200+ employees) in sectors such as financial services, healthcare, legal, and engineering consultancy, which handle confidential client or employee data and cannot expose it to third-party AI platforms. The most important customer category within the grant horizon is public universities and government institutions, because they combine strong data-sovereignty drivers, existing digitisation investments waiting to be unlocked, and predictable procurement cycles. Private enterprise represents near-term revenue; public institutions represent the strategic long-term market.
3. Value Proposition <i>(Please briefly describe which problems of the customers are your company trying to solve? What products or services does company offer to your customers? Which specific customer segments needs are satisfying by your company with your new product/service?) Maximum 200 words</i>
Enclave gives institutions the productivity benefits of modern AI — conversational Q&A over their documents, AI-assisted report drafting, business insights, and AI-driven recruitment — without any data ever leaving their security perimeter. Problems solved: (a) Manual document search consumes administrative time and slows decisions; (b) existing AI tools (ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot) cannot be used on sensitive institutional data; (c) recruitment screening is slow, inconsistent, and unauditable; (d) prior digitisation investments sit as passive archives, yielding little return.

What Enclave offers: A unified, sovereign AI platform — deployable fully on-premise or in private cloud — combining an Enterprise Knowledge Management module (Q&A, report drafting, business insights) and a Recruitment / Talent Intelligence module, both built on the same validated document-ingestion and retrieval core.

Needs satisfied: Data sovereignty and regulatory alignment; citation-backed, auditable AI responses; role-based access control; Sinhala / Tamil / English document handling; procurement-eligible security credentials; and deployment automation that fits Sri Lankan institutional IT environments.

Why it is differentiated: No dominant locally-developed sovereign AI platform exists today. Global cloud AI tools are structurally unsuitable. Enclave is Sri Lankan-built, Sri Lankan-operated, and designed for Sri Lankan compliance realities.

4. Distribution Channels *(Please briefly describe how your company reach to your customer segments for delivering products/services? How customer can order/re-order your products/services. Sales are done by your own channels or via partner channels)* **Maximum 200 words**

Enclave reaches customers through a combination of direct sales and partner-enabled channels, with the emphasis in the Start-up phase on direct-led client acquisition to build reference customers and pricing discipline.

Direct channels. A dedicated Business Development / Client Acquisition function (funded in the project budget) drives outreach to target organisations in public-sector, higher-education, and private-enterprise segments. This includes proposal issuance, solution demonstrations, procurement-process navigation, on-site presentations, and contract closure. Digital marketing (content, targeted campaigns, case-study publication) generates inbound leads and supports the direct sales motion.

Partner channels. SLT Mobitel incubation support (following the Entrepreneurship Studio 2025 win) extends market reach through Mobitel's enterprise and public-sector relationships. Over time, Enclave will build partnerships with systems integrators and managed-service providers already serving public institutions, as referral and implementation partners.

Ordering and re-ordering. Initial engagements are contracted via licence agreements with annual subscription renewals, implementation services, and customer-success-led expansion (add-on modules, additional user seats, additional sites). The on-premise nature of the product means delivery occurs through guided deployment at the customer site rather than self-service sign-up.

5. Customer Relationships *(Please describe the types of relationships a company establishes with specific customer segment. how your company get, keep, and grow your customers? Why will they like you? How your company form a relationship with customers)* **Maximum 200 words**

Enclave's customer relationships are **high-touch, consultative, and long-term**, appropriate to enterprise software sold into regulated and document-intensive institutions.

Acquisition. Direct sales engagement begins with discovery workshops to understand the customer's document landscape, governance constraints, and use cases. A scoped demonstration on representative customer data (in a controlled environment) establishes credibility before any contract commitment. Procurement navigation support is provided for public-sector buyers.

Retention. Every customer receives a dedicated implementation engagement, administrator training, and an onboarding playbook, followed by a named customer-success contact for ongoing support. Annual subscription renewals are anchored by an annual business review that quantifies usage, time saved, and new use cases. An SLA-backed support tier ensures operational confidence.

Growth. Initial deployments typically start in a single department or use case; expansion comes from extending to additional departments, additional document types, or adding modules (e.g., starting with Knowledge Management and adding Recruitment later). Reference-customer relationships generate peer-to-peer referrals within the tight Sri Lankan public and enterprise networks.

Why customers stay. Switching an on-premise AI platform carries high re-indexing, re-training, and re-integration costs. Combined with continued governance alignment and responsive local support, retention economics are strong.

6. Revenue Stream *(Please briefly describe how your company make money or generate cash from each customer segment? How do you set prices? Will there be a customer willingness to pay for your product or service other than going for another? Are you selling, producing or doing both?) Maximum 200 words*

Enclave generates revenue through four complementary streams, designed for predictability and compatibility with Sri Lankan public-sector procurement practice.

(i) Annual subscription licence fees. The core platform is licensed on an annual subscription basis, priced per deployment site and scaled by user count or document volume tier. This generates predictable recurring revenue and aligns with institutional budgeting cycles.

(ii) Implementation and customisation services. Initial deployment engagements are billed as fixed-scope professional services covering installation, customer-specific data onboarding, integration with existing systems, and administrator training. Ongoing customisation is billed on a time-and-materials basis.

(iii) Support and maintenance. Annual support contracts, tiered by response-time SLA, are sold alongside licences. This includes software updates, security patches, and helpdesk access.

(iv) Add-on modules. Customers starting with one module (Knowledge Management or Recruitment) can expand to the other or to advanced capabilities (audit analytics, cross-document linking, advanced reporting) for incremental licence fees.

Pricing and willingness-to-pay. Pricing is anchored against the cost of existing cloud AI tools (which target customers cannot use), the labour cost of manual document-handling workflows, and the implicit risk premium of data-sovereignty breaches. Early pilot deployments are priced as paid commercial engagements — not free trials — to validate willingness-to-pay from day one.

7. Key Resources *(Please briefly describe the most important assets required to make your business model work. What key resources (Man, Machine, Material and Money) that contribute to create your products/ service? any resources barrow, rent or own, Any intellectual property exploitation)* **Maximum 200 words**

Intellectual property. The validated technology platform developed under the prior NSF Technology Development Grant — document ingestion pipeline, hybrid keyword-and-vector retrieval architecture, retrieval-augmented generation engine, on-premise LLM fine-tuning stack, Q&A and report-drafting modules, and the CV parsing / candidate-ranking engine. Patent filings on the novel technical components (Sri Lanka and PCT) will establish defensible IP assets for the spin-off entity. The Enclave trademark and associated brand assets are also core resources.

Human resources. Two founder-level leaders (AI/ML and security architecture), one funded engineering hire for the project, one business-development hire for client acquisition, and senior technical leadership (in-kind). External specialist consultants are engaged narrowly for ISO 27001 readiness, PDPA alignment, and IP law.

Physical and infrastructure resources. Established office premises (owned by Alta Vision), development workstations and staging hardware, source control and CI/CD infrastructure, and cloud staging environments for development, fine-tuning, and inference testing.

Operational resources. Two existing production customer deployments serving as reference sites, an active commercial pipeline with positive ongoing conversations, SLT Mobitel incubation support from the Entrepreneurship Studio 2025 win, and a track record of successful delivery against the prior NSF grant.

8. Key Activities *(Please briefly describe the most important things a company must do to make its business model work. What are the key activities from value preposition, distribution channel, customer relationship etc.? What are your main activities of your products or services production, delivering, marketing, problem solving, administration & organization)* **Maximum 200 words**

Productisation. Consolidating the Enterprise Knowledge Management and Recruitment modules into a unified Enclave platform with shared administration, authentication, and deployment tooling. Extending the ingestion and transcription pipelines to handle Sinhala and Tamil in addition to English. Building deployment automation and installer packaging to reduce per-customer deployment effort from weeks to hours.

Certification and compliance. ISO 27001 readiness assessment, independent third-party penetration testing, and formal alignment audit against the Personal Data Protection Act (No. 9 of 2022) and ICTA Government Cloud Policy — the credentials required for Sri Lankan enterprise and public-sector procurement.

Client acquisition and marketing. Direct outreach to target institutions, solution demonstrations, proposal issuance, procurement navigation, and contract closure for three to five paid pilot deployments during the grant period. Digital marketing, brand and collateral development, content publication, and reference-customer case studies.

Intellectual property protection. Patent filings (Sri Lanka + PCT), trademark registration of the Enclave brand, and copyright/trade-secret protections.

Spin-off and commercial launch. Incorporation of Enclave (Pvt) Ltd, IP and contract transfer from Alta Vision, launch of the formal commercial licensing model, and leveraging SLT Mobitel incubation support for market visibility.

Operations and delivery. Customer implementation, training, support, and success management across the growing pilot and post-launch customer base.

9. Key Partners *(Please briefly describe the networks of suppliers and partners that makes the business model work. Who are your key partners and possible partners? Who are your key suppliers and competitors? Which key resources do you acquire from suppliers?) Maximum 200 words*

SLT Mobitel. Incubation partner following the Entrepreneurship Studio 2025 programme win. Provides market visibility, enterprise and public-sector relationship access, and mentorship — extending commercial reach beyond direct sales channels at no incremental cost to the project.

Alta Vision (Pvt) Ltd. The applicant and parent entity during the grant period. Provides office premises, development infrastructure, senior technical leadership (in-kind), and the entity within which the project operates until Enclave (Pvt) Ltd is incorporated and the IP and contracts are transferred.

Reference customers. The two existing production deployment sites provide ongoing operational feedback, performance data, and testimonial support.

Specialist consultants. ISO 27001 readiness consultants, a PDPA / data-protection advisor, a third-party penetration-testing firm, and IP legal counsel (Sri Lankan + international PCT). Each is engaged for narrow, specialist scope where independent sign-off or specialist expertise is required.

Procurement and systems-integration partners (emerging). Over the course of the project, relationships will be developed with systems integrators and managed-service providers active in the Sri Lankan public-sector market, as future referral and implementation partners.

Competitors. Global cloud AI tools (ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Google Workspace AI) — structurally unable to address the sovereignty-constrained segments — and local enterprise software vendors lacking AI capability.

10. Cost structure *(Please briefly describe all costs incurred to operate a business model. What are the important costs that may incur in production, delivering your product or service? E.g., Raw material cost, electricity, water, rent, building, equipment etc.) Maximum 200 words*

The cost structure is dominated by **personnel and infrastructure**, reflecting Enclave's nature as a software-product business.

Personnel (largest cost category). Engineering staff for platform consolidation, localisation, deployment automation, and customer implementation; business-development staff for client acquisition; senior technical leadership (founders and co-lead); and customer-success / support staff as the customer base grows. Personnel accounts for the majority of ongoing operating cost.

Cloud and software infrastructure. Cloud staging, LLM fine-tuning compute, inference compute for demo and evaluation environments, software licences (development tools, APIs, testing platforms), source control, CI/CD, and observability tooling. Growing with technical scope and customer count.

Client acquisition costs. Digital marketing, content and brand development, sales-cycle expenses including site visits, demonstrations, and proposal production. Disciplined ROI tracking ensures customer-acquisition cost remains well below customer lifetime value.

Compliance and certification. ISO 27001 readiness, annual audit and renewal cycles, penetration testing, and PDPA alignment costs. Largely front-loaded in the project period, then recurring annually.

Intellectual property. Patent filing and maintenance (Sri Lanka + PCT), trademark registration, IP legal counsel.

Office and administration. Office space (absorbed by Alta Vision during the grant; modest post-spinoff), equipment depreciation, accounting, legal, banking, and insurance.

Declaration by Applicant:

Hereby I certify that the above information provided by me are true to my knowledge.



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Signature of the Applicant -Team Leader

23/04/2026

Date

Please e-mail your duly completed BMC along with EoI to techg@nsf.gov.lk. The original hard copy will be requested if needed during the evaluation process. Incomplete applications will not be processed. NSF decision pertaining to evaluation of EoIs and detail applications will be the final.

For more information: Tel: 0112696771/ Ext. 141 (Grant Coordinators) and 120 (Head/TDID)